

August 11, 2026

Doctor Andres Barrios-Fernandez
Universidad de Los Andes

Decision on your re-submission to *The Economic Journal*: “Effects of Geographic Specialization on Police Effectiveness” (second version)

Dear Doctor Barrios-Fernandez,

Thank you for submitting your fascinating paper to *The Economic Journal*.

I have now heard back from the reviewers and read your revised paper. The news is rather good. R3 has signed off on the paper. R2 has a few comments, which are rather conditional-acceptance material. R1 is pleased with the revision but still has issues regarding the interpretation of your results and the overall framing of the paper. I agree with them. I think we have established that your paper makes a contribution to the literature; now is the time to acknowledge very precisely what can and cannot be said about the results. Please provide further evidence to support the current interpretation of the results if you can and if the evidence supports it (the reviewer has suggestions). Also, please revise the framing so that the results, interpretations, and framing are well aligned. At this stage, I would like you to be mindful of readers and start condensing your paper to maximise readability and impact. I think there is room to cut around 5 pages and to make the introduction (and the abstract) shorter, in particular (of course, do not cut anything you find crucial).

You will find detailed comments in R1's and R2's reports. As usual, I would like you to prepare a detailed, separate reply for each reviewer and revise the paper accordingly. Additionally, please prepare a separate note for me, outlining the changes made during the revision process.

After I receive your revised manuscript and replies, I will assess the progress made on the points raised by the reviewers and send the paper back to them. While there is no strict deadline for this revision, I would hope that you can return a revised manuscript within three months. Please let me know if you encounter any issues with this timeline or if anything in my letter or in the reports is unclear.

Thank you again for giving me the opportunity to read your excellent paper. I look forward to seeing the revised version.

Best,

Roland Rathelot
Editor

